March 2026

Admiral Mike Mullen, USN (Ret.)
Princeton School of Public and International Affairs
Princeton University
Princeton, NJ 08544

Dear Admiral Mullen,

You have served this republic at its highest levels of responsibility — and you have spoken publicly about a concern that goes beyond military readiness: the erosion of the civic foundation that military service ultimately exists to defend. The National Experiential Civic Education Framework addresses that erosion directly, and I am writing to ask for your support.

The framework proposes structured, hands-on civic programs in schools: community service, emergency preparedness training, infrastructure stewardship, and leadership development. Emergency preparedness training alone — built on the existing FEMA CERT program already operating in communities nationwide — would produce measurably more resilient communities and a more prepared citizenry. The leadership and cooperative challenge components mirror exactly the kind of team-building that military training has always understood to be foundational.

The national security dimension of this proposal is real. A citizenry that lacks the habits of cooperation, community resilience, and shared responsibility is not merely a civic concern — it is a strategic vulnerability. Nations whose populations are disconnected, distrustful, and incapable of collective action are less able to respond to crisis, resist division, and sustain the institutions that provide for the common defense.

Your endorsement of this framework would carry weight that no politician's endorsement can match. It would signal to Americans across the political spectrum that civic education is not an ideological project — it is a national security and community resilience imperative.

I would be honored to brief you on the full white paper and discuss what your involvement might look like. Thank you for your decades of service to this republic.

With the deepest respect,

Gina Aulabaugh